

FLAT STICK ends the week on the road to Wilcannia waiting for the water to recede. Join me next week to see if I'm still here or I've risked it & ended up like this



FLAT STICK

2



/50

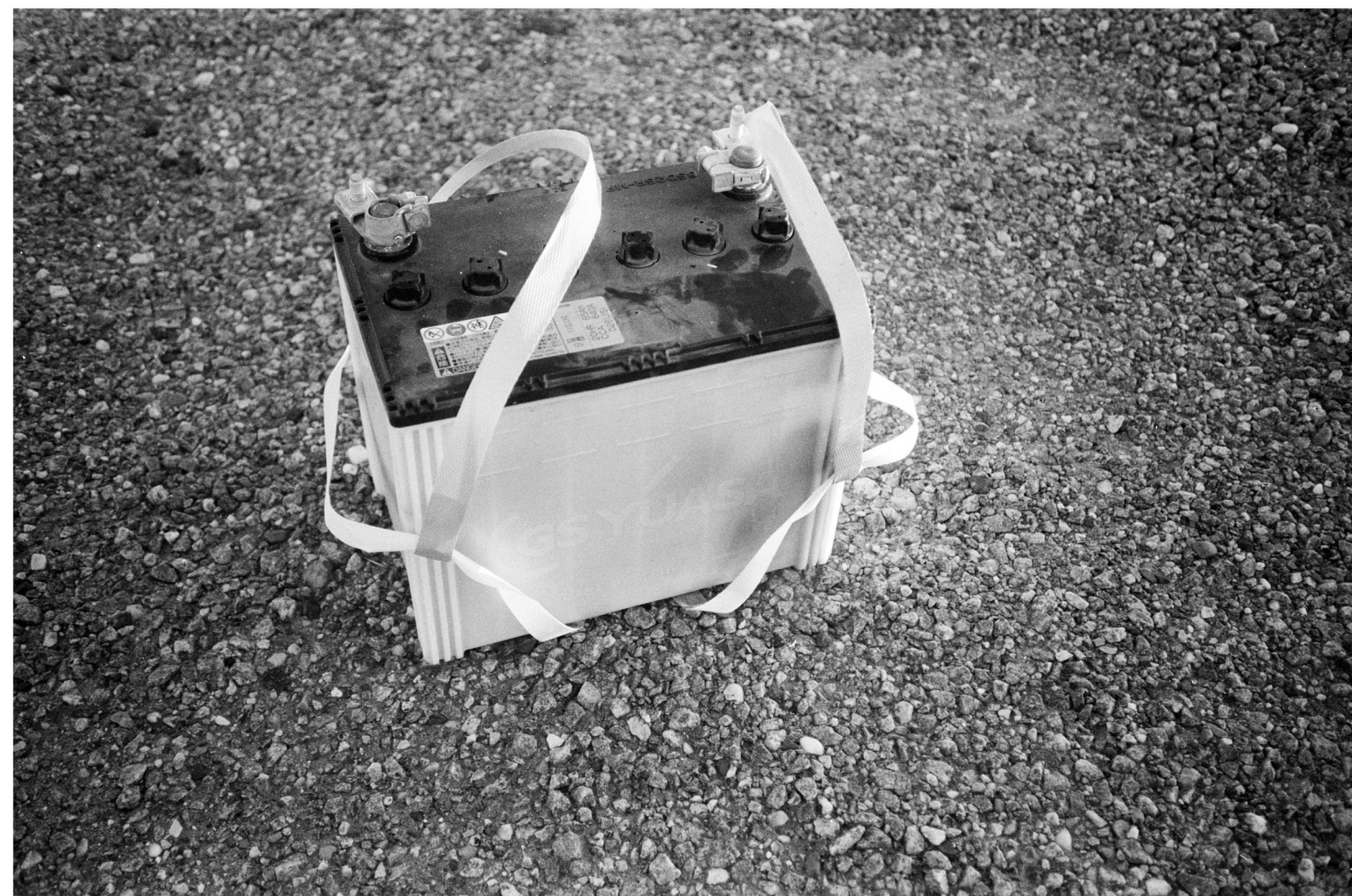
PRINTED AT

MARCH 2026

Diesel \$2.50/L

FLAT STICK is a zine documenting my trip around Australia. All photos are mine, taken on 35mm film & developed in the van. zines are printed in the great public libraries of Australia

P.S.A → Please do not take photos whilst driving, its dangerous & illegal, the cover photo was taken by a trained professional.



↑ Bugged Battery

NOTE: Blackened Marks from thermal runaway.

Installing New one



BATTERY TROUBLE

It had been a long day of prospecting in the harsh sun & after a quick shower & a tin of beans I hit the hay. I awoke at 3am feeling restless & without internet I checked my sensors & found the starter battery sitting very low at 11.8 volts!!! I started the engine to give it a charge & again 2hrs later, I thought I'll wait until morning get out of the bush & back on to the Highway, I was deep down a dirt track.

At first light I made it slowly back to the bitumen & thought it might be best to head back to Broken Hill whilst the engine is going. I thought to check the batteries, the van has 2 starter batteries in parallel, apparently for winter starts in the JAPANESE Alpine region. I found the first baking a bit of acid, the second was sizzling!!! Red hot & the acid was boiling off. I shut the engine off & disconnected the battery, it remained hot so I removed it totally. The case was bulging & had black marks. It looked like the original JAPANESE battery.

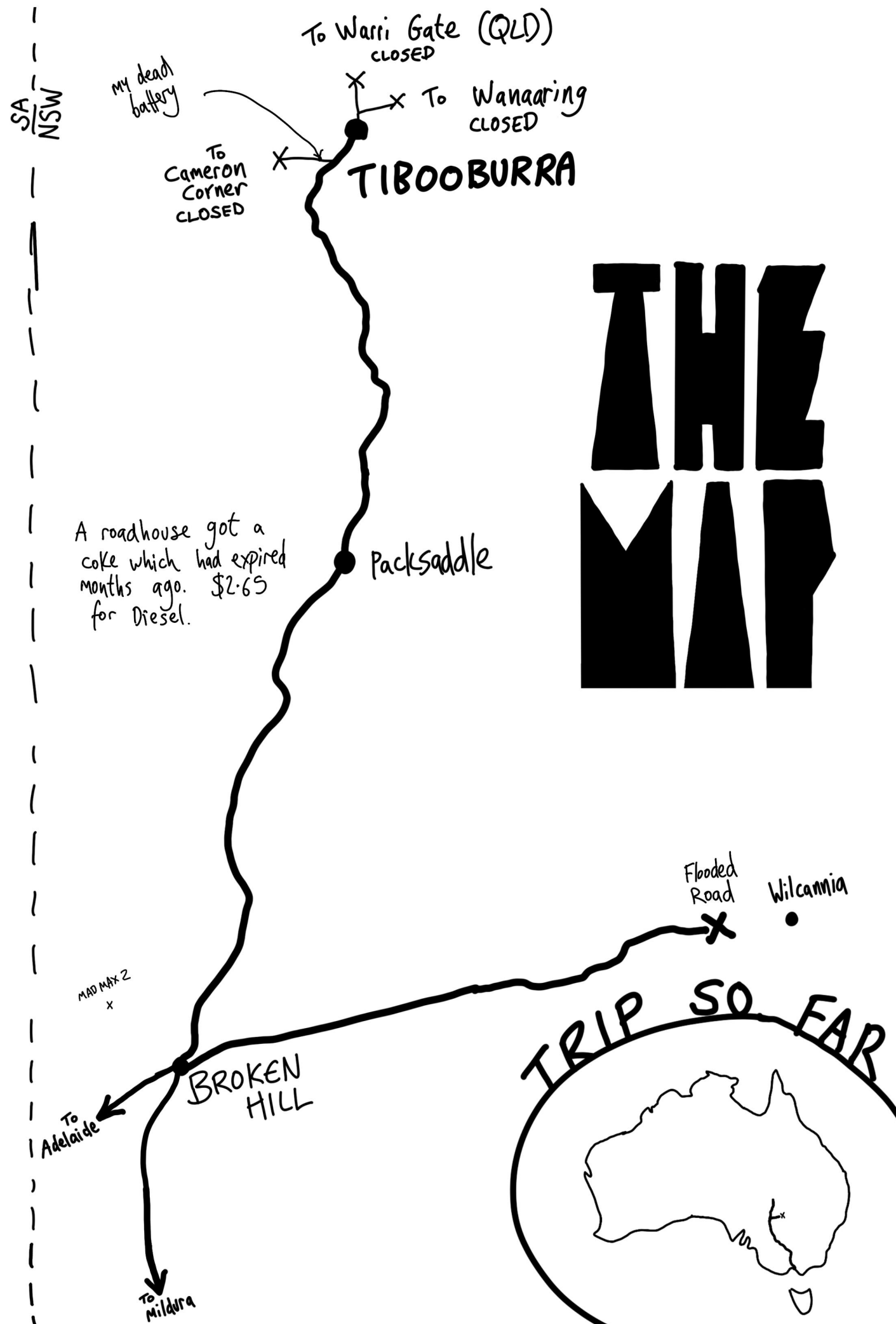
Lucky I had 2 batteries, I left the battery there & told the roadhouse, then hightailed it back to Broken Hill straight to REPCO. A little sleep deprived I swapped the battery for a new one. I felt lucky the roads were closed as I could have gone further away from a new battery.

Welcome,

Its been quite the week!
I made it through & the wheels keep turning. I'm settling in to this nomadic life & each day the news reminds me I'm doing the right thing. The struggle, is the whole point of life, it just takes time to feel that way.

love Jared _{xt}

P.S. I had to add 4 extra pages to fit everything in this week.



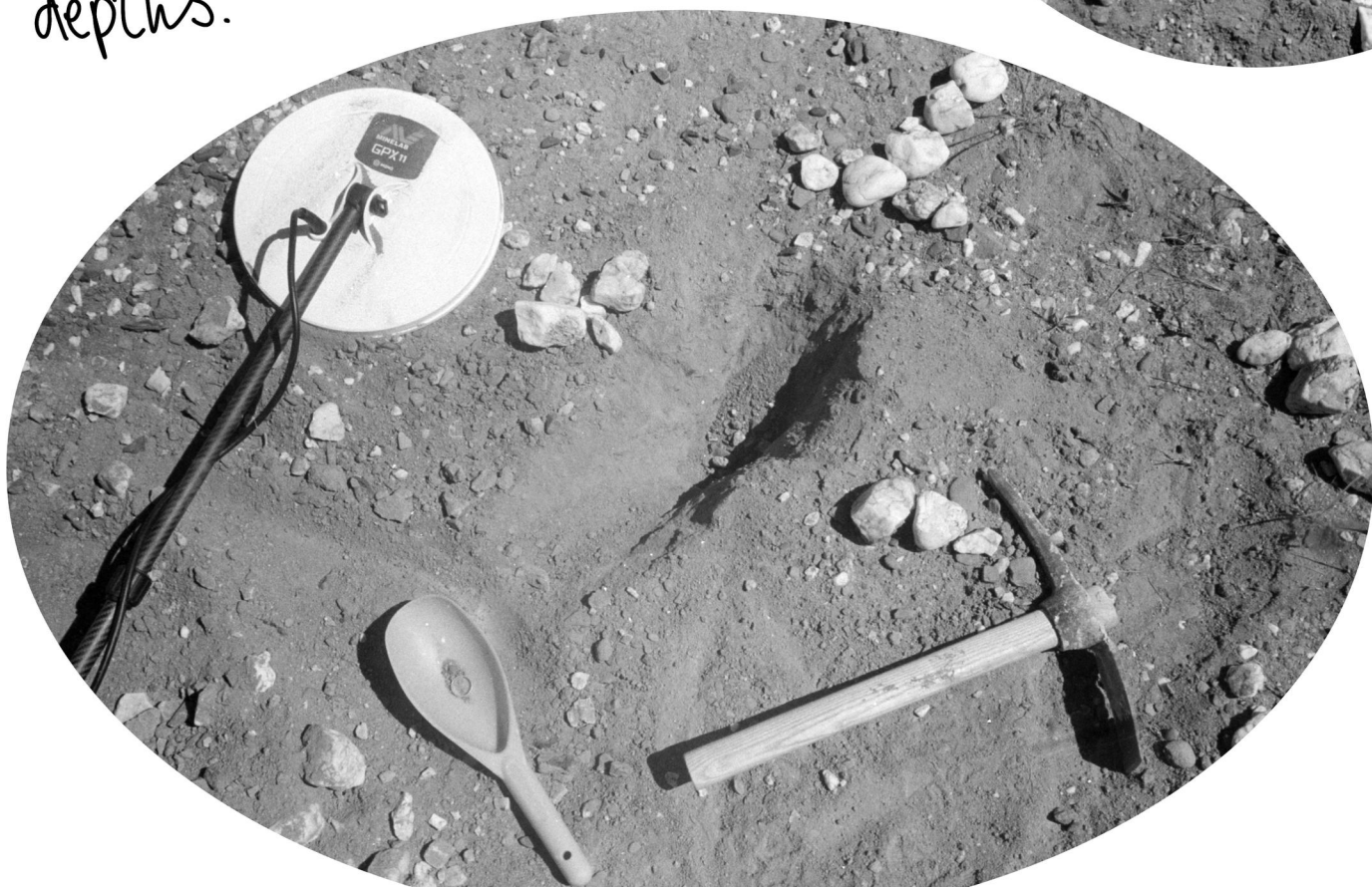
The recent floods I was hoping had exposed some new ground. I started in a few Creek beds, looking at tree roots & any exposed bedrock. I was thinking if I was a heavy piece of GOLD where would I get stuck. I met a few Kangaroos, Lizards & Swallowed I don't know how many fries. By the end of the day I had a great collection of old barbed wire, rivets & flakes of IRON. I was hoping to spend a few days prospecting however my Van had other plans, at least I got a good practice in 😊

DETECTING



I used to have a detector & I've had the gold bug a long time. In Broken Hill I had a chat with the guys at the prospecting store. A father & son team, straight talking & funny as I walked out with a good deal & the urge to get swinging.

Up in Tibooburra I decided to run a few tests to train my ear to the sound of GOLD. Two holes one with my GOLD RING & the other a piece of iron at the same depths.



BROKEN HILL

S I L V E R C I T Y

Broken Hill has always been on my bucket list, no matter what you think of mining its got to be one of the most important reasons Australia is the prosperous nation it is today. Broken Hill is the longest lived mining town in Australia, the birth place of "THE BIG AUSTRALIAN" BROKEN HILL PROPRIETARY or BHP which still stands as the worlds biggest mining company & also Australias.

Its name comes from the explorer Charles Sturt who referred to a broken hill, the hill he saw has been mined away now. Its also known as the SILVER CITY that being the first thing mined, along with lead & Zinc.

I enjoyed my time here, everyone seemed so genuine & helpful. It had that vintage charm so many old towns have. I enjoyed seeing the history, the old & new combining. I was lucky to see it after the rains the ochre landscape turning green.

Couple served me & said I can get a permit for "The Commons" starts at the first Cattle grid & ends at the next. CASH ONLY \$20.

I handed over a lobster & left with my permit, ready to get swinging

TIBOOBURRA COMMON TRUST
Permit to Prospect
Rules for Prospecting / Visiting the Common

3203

1. Drive on formed tracks and roads only.
2. No firearms permitted on the Common.
3. Do not remove any dead timber, logs or tree stumps (firewood), (either standing or down).
4. No fires permitted.
5. Do not carry or use any explosive, net, trap or hunting device.
6. Do not capture, injure, annoy or interfere with the habitat of any animal.
7. Do not damage, dismantle or remove any machinery, equipment, building or facility.
8. Back fill all diggings (no matter how small).
9. Remove all rubbish.
10. Do not interfere with Common Stock.
11. No camping allowed on the common.
12. This permit must remain in the vehicle or on the person while on the common.

I have read and accept Tiboorurra Common Trust Rules for Prospecting.

- FEE NOT REFUNDABLE -

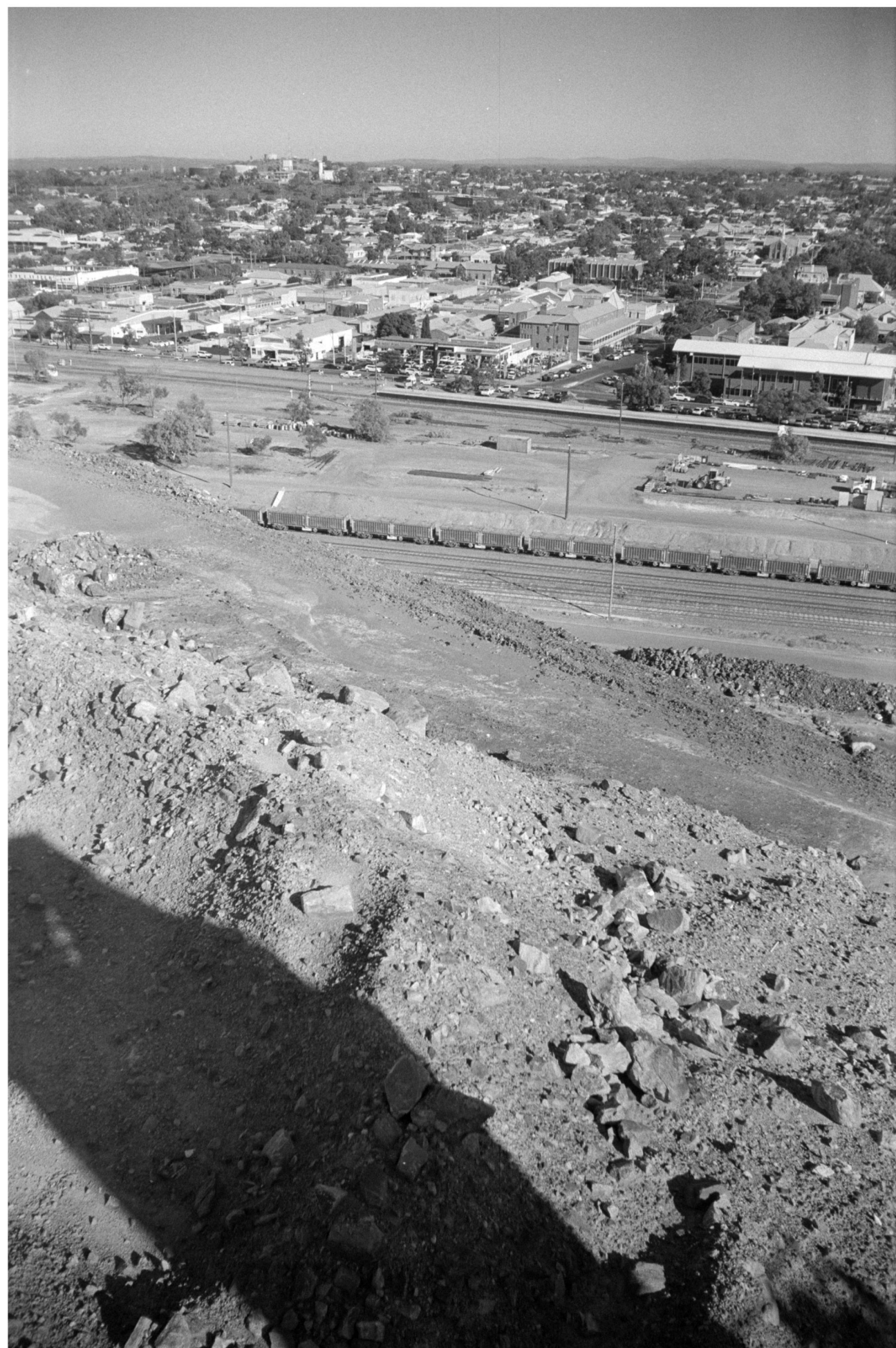
Name: JARED STONE
Signature: [Signature]
Area: Common Area
Registration Number: NSY CNT
Dates: From: 10/03/26 To: 10/04/26
Fees Paid: \$20.00
Authorising Person: [Signature] Amy McInnes
Date: 10/03/26



The Landscape was beautiful, the sun had his hat on, I had bought some sunscreen at TJ's, \$20! but it was worth it. I kept my eyes peeled & let my senses draw me down a dirt track.



A few of the animals seen on the road.





The road to Wilcannia was flooded by over 4m of water & with a few rescues needed. Only road was up but it too was effected by rain.



The old BHP mine site, DELPRAT'S SHAFT. Named after the GM of BHP sunk in 1900 & closed in 1976 becoming a tourist mine until 2007. It now sits derelict overlooking the town.

TIBOOBURRA

With the road to Wilcannia off limits & a new detector on board I hit the Silver City Hwy north hoping to enter QLD from there but also look for some GOLD in the town of Tibbooburra. The road had little traffic, the signs urging caution after the recent floods, it had only just reopened & you could tell the creek crossings were covered in mud & at times still some water. Areas where the whole top service had slipped away (see pic left). The internet dropped off quickly & I had a few days with nothing. The lack of internet at first worried me & second freed me. Its so easy to be plugged in 24/7 scared to hear your own thoughts. Windows down, wind in my hair it was a great drive up. I pulled over & slept the night, rolled into town the next morning.

I got a coffee & had a yarn all roads out of town are closed except south. She told me a guy in town she had to turn away for hoarding diesel. She gave me the run down for GOD TJs (servo), pub & two storey pub have licences for different areas. I headed to TJs (pubs were closed until evening). An old



DEAD CENTRE



FEEDBACK

If you have any thoughts, suggestions, complaints, unsolicited opinions, grievances, confessions, lengthy manifestos, leads on buried treasure, conspiracy theories, regrets, prophecies, get rich schemes, eggs, the meaning of life, other, or anything really. please send them in to the email below.

FLATSTICKZINE@GMAIL.COM

